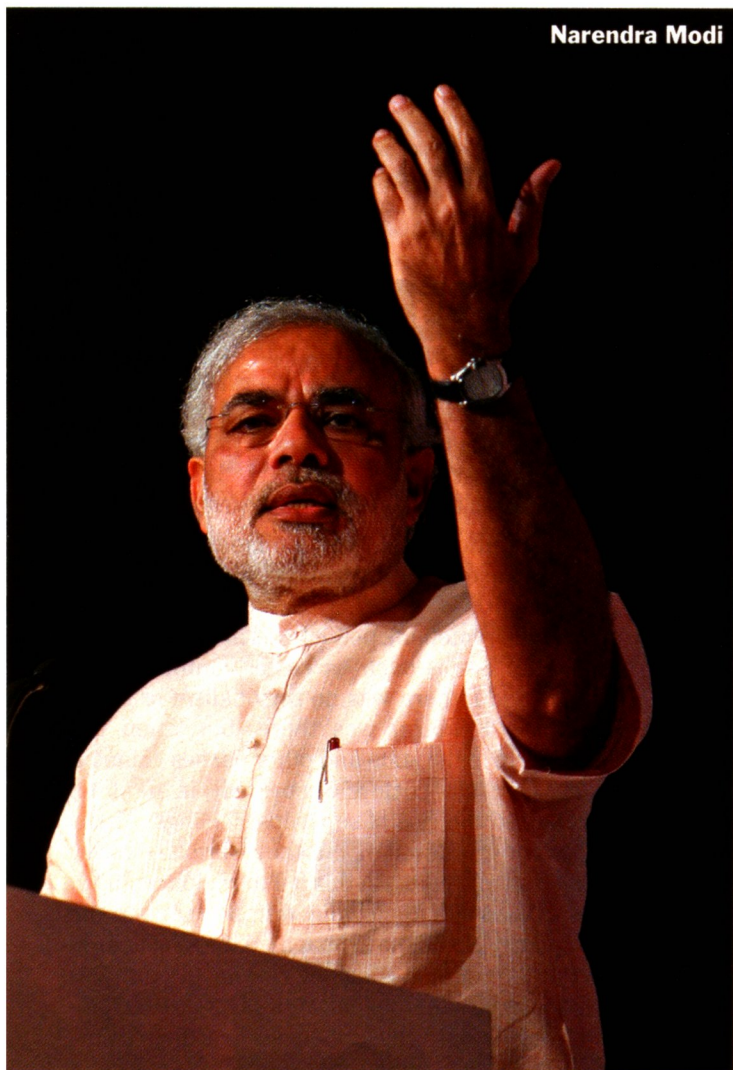


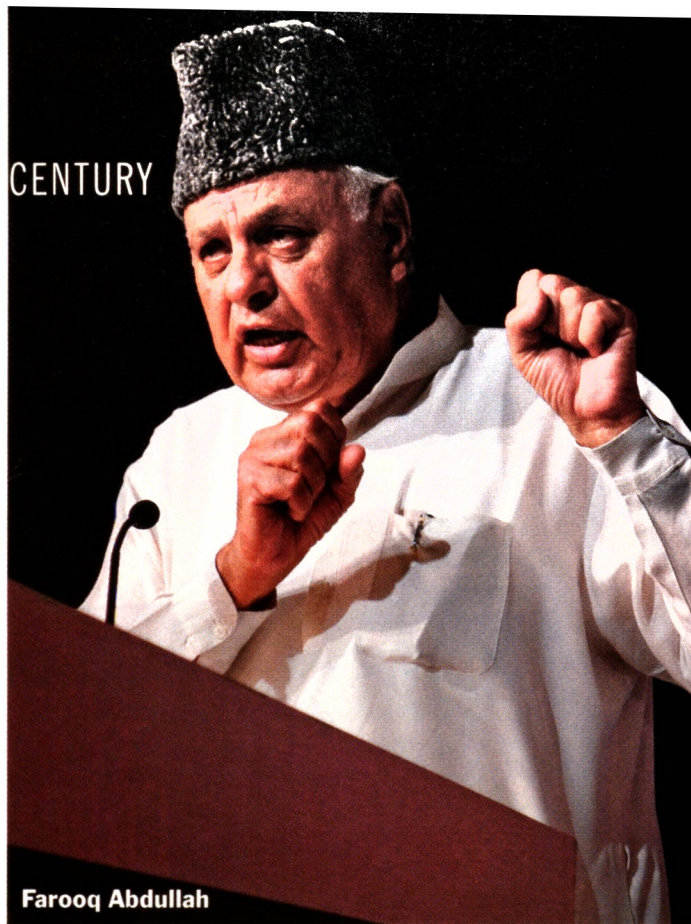
The Sachar Committee asked me, "Modiji, tell us about the steps your government has taken for Muslims," and I replied that I had done nothing. Then I also told the committee I had done nothing for Hindus too and that I am working for 5.5 crore Gujaratis instead. Through river-linking we brought the Narmada waters to the Sabarmati. Now am I going to find out which community is drinking how much of this water? That is divisive politics. I am the first leader in the country who has abolished such politics and used a new inclusive terminology—Gujaratis—to lead the state on the path of development. I speak the language of development.

In Gujarat, the power situation was in a bad shape and we had a loss of Rs 2,500 crore before I took over in 2001. I decided that the situation had to change. I decided to act against the power thieves with an iron fist. This year the same power sector has made a profit of Rs 700 crore and I didn't have to raise the power tariff to achieve it. Today, 18,000 villages get a 24-hour, uninterrupted power supply. I am of the firm belief that it is possible to defeat the politics of votebanks with the politics of development in the country. Gujarat is a shining example of that.



Narendra Modi

RAVI S SAHNI



Farooq Abdullah

RAVI S SAHNI

"Know your religion to understand the other's"

FAROOQ ABDULLAH FORMER CM, J&K

Every election in independent India has divided people. It has divided the nation into castes, religions and provinces. Will we ever change? The elections are near and you will find us starting to tie up with people we hate. To occupy the centrestage of Delhi we will even marry the devil. How can we really make leadership honest? How do we accept the fact that we are behind every single thing that goes wrong? We create communal trouble. We will put the tail of the cow in a temple and probably the head of a pig in the mosque. And then we will pay people to create tragedies whereby the whole thing will end up in flames and we will raise a hue and cry about a communal problem.

Today, we take the name of Mahatma Gandhi but we are miles away from what he believed in. I want an India where I don't have to use Mohammad or Allah to win a vote. I am not against Ram. Ram is *vishva ka Ram* (Ram for the whole world) and not only for Hindus. The same way Mohammad is *rahmatul-lil-alamein*, not *rahmatul-lil-Muslimein* (a blessing for the whole world and not just Muslims).

No religion in the world teaches hatred. It teaches love, brotherhood and compassion. Without understanding one's own religion, you can't understand the other's beliefs. Historically, we have emulated each other and accommodated each other. Let us hope we will have leaders who'll guide the destiny of this nation much higher without the bitterness that we have seen over the past 60 years.